

Government Return to Work Mandate

By Dyson & Marshall

Background

Who: Federal public servants and small downtown businesses, are all competing with remote-first companies.

What: Return-to-office mandate requiring federal workers to be in-office 4 days per week, reducing full remote flexibility

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Background pt. 2

When: Phased implementation beginning in July 2026

Why: To improve collaboration and workplace culture, support downtown economic activity, and respond to political pressure and post-pandemic work debates

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Economic Implications



- More Traffic Congestion
- Higher Costs for Employees
- Multiplier Effect on Local Businesses

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Political Reasoning

- Collaboration
- Spending Efficiency
- Employee Supervision



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Sources

<https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/federal-government-return-to-office-9.7076314>

<https://psacunion.ca/governments-4-day-office-mandate-insult-workers>

<https://policyoptions.irpp.org/2026/03/return-to-office-mandates/>

<https://obj.ca/fed-office-space-crunch-inevitable-execs-say/>